ACTIVITY 1

Assess for the presence of risk factors for heart disease in your respective family and discuss the same among your friends and family members.

ATP III classification of blood lipids

Cholesterol reading	Classification
Total cholesterol (mg/dl)	
<200	**Desirable**
200-239	**Borderline high risk**
≥ 240	**High risk**
LDL cholesterol (mg/dl)	
<100	**Optimal**
100-129	**Near optimal**
130-159	**Borderline high risk**
160-189	**High risk**
≥ 190	**Very high risk**
HDL cholesterol (mg/dl)	
≥ 60	**Optimal**
40-59	**Desirable**
<40	**High risk**
Triglycerides (mg/dl)	
<150	**Optimal**
150-199	**Borderline high risk**
≥ 200	**High risk**

Principles of diet

Low to moderate calorie, moderate fat (less saturated fat, cholesterol and high in unsaturated fats such as monounsaturated fat and poly-unsaturated fatty acids) low carbohydrate, normal protein and high fibre is recommended.

Dietary management

Energy

The total energy intake should match the energy expenditure to achieve a desirable body weight. Reducing the calorie intake and increasing the physical activity helps to reduce excess body weight and blood lipids.

Fat

Dietary fat has been shown to affect blood lipid levels. Total fat intake should not exceed 25% of total calories.

- **Saturated fat** to be restricted to 7% of total calories as it promotes an increase in blood cholesterol which in turn can lead to heart disease.

  Saturated fat is mostly present in animals foods like meat, poultry, milk and milk products. Processed foods like cakes, biscuits and pastries also contain these fats.



- **Monounsaturated fat** An intake of 20% of monounsaturated fat (MUFA) reduces the cholesterol and maintains the HDL levels. These are found in groundnut oil, soyabean oil, olive oil as well as nuts like almonds and walnuts.

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